Rock Stars Celebrate a Music School for Kids

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On Saturday, famous rock bands played a big **concert** in Los Angeles. It was a party for the Silverlake Conservatory of Music, a music school for kids. The school turned 25 years old. The **concert** also **raised money** for the school.

Flea, the **bass player** of Red Hot Chili Peppers, helped start the school in 2001. Today it teaches music to 1,000 students each week. More than 200 students whose families cannot pay get free lessons and instruments.

Students played first! A student band called the SCM All Stars performed, and so did a student **brass band**. It was Flea's birthday weekend, so he got a birthday cake on stage.

Then Dave Grohl sang "My Hero," and his band, Foo Fighters, surprised everyone by joining him. Red Hot Chili Peppers played last.

Anahit, a student who started lessons at age 6, said music "brings such a good **community**."

Word Treasure

concert -- A concert is a show where musicians play music for an audience.

raised money -- Raised money means collected money to help a good cause.

bass player -- A bass player plays the bass guitar, which makes low, deep sounds.

brass band -- A brass band is a group that plays metal horns like trumpets and tubas.

community -- A community is a group of people who share something and care about each other.

Background you need

A music school teaches kids how to sing and play instruments.

Music lessons can cost a lot, so some schools give free lessons to kids whose families cannot pay.

A concert can raise money when fans buy tickets to help a good cause.

Break it down

WHO: Red Hot Chili Peppers, Dave Grohl and Foo Fighters, and student musicians
WHAT: A concert to celebrate a kids' music school turning 25
WHERE: Los Angeles
WHY: To raise money for the Silverlake Conservatory of Music, which gives kids lessons, including free ones

Why it matters

It helps more kids learn to play music, even if their families cannot pay for lessons.

Test what you remember

1. What was the concert celebrating?

- (A) A new movie
- (B) A music school for kids turning 25
- (C) A birthday party only
- (D) A football win

2. Which city was the concert in?

- (A) New York
- (B) Los Angeles
- (C) London
- (D) Rome

3. Who helped start the school?

- (A) Anahit
- (B) Dave Grohl
- (C) Flea, the bass player of Red Hot Chili Peppers
- (D) A teacher from Italy

4. How many students does the school teach each week?

- (A) 200
- (B) 25
- (C) 6
- (D) 1,000

5. Who played first?

- (A) Nobody
- (B) Students from the school
- (C) Red Hot Chili Peppers
- (D) Foo Fighters

6. What surprise happened when Dave Grohl sang 'My Hero'?

- (A) He played a piano
- (B) It started to rain
- (C) His band, Foo Fighters, joined him
- (D) The lights went out

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: B 3: C 4: D 5: B 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Anahit, a student: She says music brings people together into a good community.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):